Here are some of the notes I made in my diary during the period immediately after Gemayel's assassination:

Sept. 19

A busy day for N.S.C. State and defense and staff. I attended meeting in the morning re the Beirut massacre. The Israelis did finally attempt to oust the killers. They have proclaimed their outrage. I finally told our group we should go for broke.

Let's tell the people we are at the request of the Lebanese sending the multi-national force back in. Italy has agreed and we believe the French will too. We are asking the Israelis to leave Beirut. We are asking Arabs to intervene and persuade Syrians to leave Lebanon at which time we'll ask Israelis to do likewise. In the meantime, Lebanon will establish a government and the capability of defending itself. No more half way gesture, clear the whole situation while the M.N.F. is on hand to assure order.

George Shultz and Jeane K. were enthusiastic about the idea and apparently there was no disagreement. The wheels are now in motion . . .

Sept. 20

Spent the morning in an NSPG [National Security Planning Group] meeting framing what I would say or rather how I'd say it on TV, what we were going to do in Lebanon. Anyway, at 5 p.m. I said it: all three networks from Oval Office. . . .

Sept. 26

Our Marines were to have landed in Lebanon but now it will be Tuesday. It is Yom Kippur so the Israelis won't be out until Tuesday but they have agreed to withdraw.

Yesterday we lost two officials in Lebanon. They were assigned to the UN as observers. They and an Irish and